

Robert Kubinec

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Current position

2026- Associate Professor of Political Science, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University

Previous positions

2026-2026 Associate Professor of Political Science, Department of Political Science, University of South Carolina
2024-2026 Assistant Professor of Political Science, Department of Political Science, University of South Carolina
2019-2024 Assistant Professor of Political Science, Social Sciences Division, New York University Abu Dhabi
2018-2019 Postdoctoral Research Scholar, Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance, Princeton University

Education

2018 PhD in Foreign Affairs (Major field: Comparative Political Science), University of Virginia
2010 MA in Middle East Studies, George Washington University
2008 BA in International Relations, Wheaton College

Languages

English (native), French, Arabic, Slovak

Publications

Books

- 2023 Kubinec, Robert. *Making Democracy Safe for Business: Corporate Politics During the Arab Uprisings*. Cambridge University Press.

- Podcast with Marc Lynch, Project on Middle East Political Science

Journal Articles

- 2026 Geller, Jason; Kubinec, Robert; Pelleriti, Chelsea; and Vuorre, Matti. "A Beta Way: A Tutorial For Using Beta Regression in Psychological Research." Forthcoming in *Behavior Research Methods*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/d6v5t_v1.
- 2026 Kubinec, Robert and Yakout, Amr. "Measuring the Emperor's Clothes: Estimating Latent Opposition to Authoritarian Regimes with Randomized Response Questions." *Middle East Law and Governance*. Forthcoming. doi:10.1163/18763375-bja10020
- In Special Issue "Quantitative Methods in the Political Science of the Arab Region."
 - OSF Preprint: doi:10.31235/osf.io/ejbns_v2
- 2025 Francis, David and Kubinec, Robert. "Beyond Political Connections : A Measurement Model Approach to Estimating Firm-level Political Influence in 41 Countries." Forthcoming at *Political Science Research and Methods*. doi:10.1017/psrm.2025.10046
- 2025 Dolan, Lindsay; Kubinec, Robert; Nielson, Daniel, and Zhang, Jack. "The Impact of Information on Corporate Political Activity: A Survey Experiment on U.S. Businesses." *Business and Politics*. doi:10.1017/bap.2024.41
- Winner of the David P. Baron Prize for the best article in *Business & Politics*
 - OSF Preprint: doi:10.31235/osf.io/435u9
- 2025 Kubinec, Robert; Carvalho, Luiz Max; Barcelo, Joan; Cheng, Cindy; Messerschmidt, Luca; Cottrell, Matthew Sean and Duba, Derek. "A Bayesian Latent Variable Model for the Optimal Identification of Disease Incidence Rates Given Information Constraints." *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series A*. doi:10.1093/jrssa/qnae040
- OSF Preprint: doi:10.31235/osf.io/jp4wk
- 2024 Kubinec, Robert; Barcelo, Joan; Goldszmidt, Rafael; Grujic, Vanja; Model, Timothy; Schenk, Caress; Cheng, Cindy; Hale, Thomas; Spencer Hartnett; Allison, Messerschmidt, Luca; Petherick, Anna, and Thorvaldsdottir, Svanhildur. "Cross-National Measures of the Intensity of COVID-19 Public Health Policies." *Journal of Politics*. doi:10.1086/734241.
- OSF Preprint: doi:10.31235/osf.io/rn9xk

- 2024 Cheng, Cindy; Messerschmidt, Luca; Bravo, Isaac; Waldbauer, Marco; Bhavikatti, Rohan; Schenck, Caress; Grujic, Vanja; Model, Tim, and Kubinec, Robert. "Harmonizing Government Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic." *Scientific Data*. doi:10.1038/s41597-023-02881-x.
- OSF Preprint: doi:10.31219/osf.io/zb6yx
- 2023 Cheng, Cindy; Messerschmidt, Luca; Bravo, Isaac; Waldbauer, Marco; Bhavikatti, Rohan; Schenck, Caress; Grujic, Vanja; Model, Tim, and Kubinec, Robert. "A General Primer for Harmonizing Data." *Scientific Data*. doi:10.1038/s41597-024-02956-3.
- OSF Preprint: doi:10.31219/osf.io/baf2j
- 2023 Kubinec, Robert and Milner, Helen. "Taxes in the Time of Revolution: An Experimental Test of the Rentier State during Algeria's Hirak." *World Politics*. doi:10.1353/wp.2024.a924508.
- OSF Preprint: doi:10.31235/osf.io/hu3vq
- 2023 Kubinec, Robert; Lee, Haillie and Tomashevskiy, Andrey. "Why Corporate Political Connections Can Impede Investment." *Comparative Political Studies* doi:10.1177/00104140231204227.
- 2022 Kilavuz, Tahir; Grewal, Sharan and Kubinec, Robert. "Ghosts of the Black Decade: How Legacies of Violence Shaped Algeria's Hirak Protests." *Journal of Peace Research* doi:10.1177/00223433221137613.
- 2022 Kubinec, Robert. "Ordered Beta Regression: A Parsimonious, Well-Fitting Model for Continuous Data with Lower and Upper Bounds." *Political Analysis* doi:10.1017/pan.2022.20.
- 2022 Barcelo, Joan; Kubinec, Robert; Cheng, Cindy; Hoyer Rahn, Tiril; and Messerschmidt, Luca. "Windows of Repression: Using COVID-19 Policies against Political Dissidents?" *Journal of Peace Research* doi:10.1177/00223433211062389.
- 2021 Kubinec, Robert; Lee, Haillie and Tomashevskiy, Andrey. "Politically-Connected Companies Are Less Likely to Shutdown Due to COVID-19 Restrictions." *Social Science Quarterly*. doi:10.1111/ssqu.13040.
- 2020 Kubinec, Robert and Owen, John. "When Groups Fall Apart: Identifying Transnational Polarization with Twitter from the Arab Uprisings." *Political Analysis* doi:10.1017/pan.2020.46.
- 2020 Cheng, Cindy; Barcelo, Joan; Hartnett, Allison; Kubinec, Robert and Messerschmidt, Luca. "COVID-19 Government Response Event Dataset (CoronaNet v.1.0)." *Nature Human Behavior*. doi:10.1038/s41562-020-0909-7.
- 2020 Kropko, Jonathan and Kubinec, Robert. "Why the Two-way Fixed Effects Model is Difficult to Interpret, and What to Do About It." *PLOS One*. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0231349

Working Papers

- 2026 Kubinec, Robert, and Mahajan, Aseem. “Fifty Shades of Greenwashing: The Political Economy of Climate Change Advertising on Social Media.” *Archiv Preprint*. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2511.14930.
- Under review
- 2025 Kubinec, Robert; Bhandari, Abhit; Jabateh, Sekou, and Mighri, Hamza. “The Political Nature of Entrepreneurship in Developing Countries: Experimental Evidence from Tunisia and Senegal.” *SocArchiv Preprint*. doi:10.31219/osf.io/unby5
- Under review
- 2024 Kubinec, Robert. “Holistic Causal Learning with Causal Graphs: A Credible Method for Study Design and Preregistration in the Social Sciences.” *SocArchiv Preprint*. doi:10.31235/osf.io/a492b
- Under review
- 2024 Kubinec, Robert; Morse, Anna and Pandya, Sonal. “Offshore Capital and Onshore Discrimination: The Biased Effects of India’s Anti-corruption Campaigns on Muslim Businesses.” *SocArchiv Preprint*. doi:10.31235/osf.io/aqtxs
- Under review
- 2025 Kubinec, Robert. “Generalized Ideal Point Models for Robust Measurement with Dirty Data in the Social Sciences.” *SocArchiv Preprint*. doi:10.31219/osf.io/8j2bt
- Under review
- 2019 Kubinec, Robert and Grewal, Sharan. “When National Unity Governments are neither National, United, nor Governments: The Case of Tunisia.” *SocArchiv Preprint*. doi:10.31235/osf.io/6z74r
- 2018 Kubinec, Robert. “Patrons or Clients? Measuring and Experimentally Evaluating Political Connections of Firms in Morocco and Jordan.” *Economic Research Forum Working Paper Series*. No. 1280. <https://erf.org.eg/publications/patrons-or-clients-measuring-and-experimentally-ev>

Reports and Op-eds

- 2026 Kubinec, Robert, “As Syria ponders a democratic future: 5 lessons from the Arab Spring,” *The Conversation*

- 2025 Kubinec, Robert, “As Syria ponders a democratic future: 5 lessons from the Arab Spring.”, *The Conversation*
- 2024 Kubinec, Robert, “Aleppo Fell. The Rest of the Middle East Is Wobbling.”, *The Bulwark*
- 2023 Kubinec, Robert, and Amr, Yakout, “Kais Saied: How the fear bias affects the opinions of Tunisians”, *Inkyfada Data Stories*
- 2023 Kubinec, Robert, “Arabs Want Democracy–But Not With Corruption”, *Cambridge University Press 518 Blog*
- 2022 Kubinec, Robert and Mighri, Hamza, “Tunisia Faces the Specter of Government Failure”, *Carnegie Endowment for International Peace*
- 2022 Kubinec, Robert, “COVID-19 Responses in the Middle East and North Africa in Global Perspective”, *Project on Middle East Political Science*
- 2022 Dolan, Lindsay; Kubinec, Robert; Nielson, Daniel; and Zhang, Jack. “Trump’s Trade War with China Failed. Why Didn’t US Companies Push Back More?”, *Washington Post*
- 2021 Kubinec, Robert, (Spring 2021), “Pandemic Safe Research with Online Surveys”, *American Political Science Association MENA Politics Newsletter*
- 2020 Kubinec, Robert, (April 2020), “The CoronaNet Database”, *Project on Middle East Political Science Studies No. 39*
- 2019 Grewal, Sharan; Kilavuz, Tahir M.; and Kubinec, Robert, (July 2019), “Algeria’s Uprising: A Survey of Protesters and the Military”, *The Brookings Institution*
- 2016 Kubinec, Robert, (Dec. 19, 2016), “How Foreign Aid Could Hurt Tunisia’s Transition to Democracy”, *Washington Post*

Software

- 2026 Kubinec, Robert. *elicitcausal*: Web App for Building Theoretically-Informative Causal Graphs.
- 2022 Kubinec, Robert. *ordbetareg*: Ordered Beta Regression Models with Brms. CRAN link
- 2022 Kubinec, Robert. *idealstan*: An R Package for Bayesian Ideal Point Modeling. Github link
- Model, Timothy and Kubinec, Robert. *CoronaNetR*: Access CoronaNet COVID-19 Policy Data. CRAN link

Grants and fellowships

External

2020	European Unions Horizon 2020 for “CoronaNet Government Response Event Datasets” (€835k)
2019	Koch Foundation Grant for “Online Survey Research on the U.S. - China Trade War” (\$10k)
2017-2018	Economic Research Forum, “A Survey of Firm-Level Political Participation” (\$6k)
2017	Koch Foundation Dissertation Grant (\$5k)
2016	Project on Middle East Political Science Travel, Research & Engagement Grant (\$3k)

Internal

2024	Faculty Research Grant (\$10k)
2020	COVID-19 Facilitator Research Fund (\$30k)
2017	Quantitative Collaborative Bynum Grant
2015 - 2016	Quandt International Research Fund travel grant, University of Virginia
2015	Summer Research Grant, Graduate School for Arts and Sciences, University of Virginia
2014-2015	Developing Students for Leadership in Data-intensive Research and Innovation fellowship, Data Science Institute, University of Virginia
2014	Summer Foreign Language Fellowship, University of Virginia
2008-2010	Elliott School High Achievement Fellowship, George Washington University
2009	Banville Tuition Fellowship, George Washington University

Invited Talks

2024	Design and Data Analysis Lecture Series, University of Virginia
2023	Department of Political Science, Universite de Montreal
2023	Governance and Local Development Institute, University of Gothenburg
2022	Connected Politics Lab, University College Dublin
2022	Summer Institute for Computational Social Science, Rutgers University
2022	Department of Political Science, Seoul National University
2021	European Union Periscope Project
2017	Tunisia Country Team, Millennial Challenge Corporation, Washington DC

Service to the Profession

Meetings

- 2023 Formateur for Pandemic Politics Conference at New York University Abu Dhabi
- 2024 Formateur for Polmeth MENA/Asia Conference at New York University Abu Dhabi

Journals & Reviewing

I have been a reviewer for *The American Political Science Review*, *The American Journal of Political Science*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Political Analysis*, *World Politics*, *Mediterranean Politics*, *Middle East Law and Governance*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *PLOS One*, *PLOS Global Public Health*, *The Japanese Journal of Political Science*, *SAGE Open*, *Global Environmental Politics*, *The Journal of Public Policy*, *The European Journal of Political Economy*, *The British Journal of Political Science*, *rOpenSci*, *Network Science*, *Scientific Reports*, and *Middle East Law and Governance*.

Editing

- 2023-2025 Evaluation Manager for Unjournal

Public Reviews

- 2025 Kubinec, Robert. *Evaluation Summary* of “Misperceptions and Demand for Democracy under Authoritarianism.” *Unjournal*. doi:10.21428/d28e8e57.ef6f66cd
- 2024 Kubinec, Robert. *Evaluation Summary* of “How Effective Is (More) Money? Randomizing Unconditional Cash Transfer Amounts in the US.” *Unjournal*. doi:10.21428/d28e8e57.8a1cac7b
- 2023 Kubinec, Robert. “Evaluation 1 of ‘Does the Squeaky Wheel Get More Grease? The Direct and Indirect Effects of Citizen Participation on Environmental Governance in China’”. *Unjournal*. <https://unjournal.pubpub.org/pub/buntaineeval1revised>.

Professional Experience & Consulting

- 2018-2019 Data Science Consultant, Source Molecular
- 2017-2018 Chief Data Scientist, Unbias
- 2011-2013 Foreign Service Officer, U.S. Department of State
- 2010-2011 Data Mining Consultant, IBM Advanced Analytics & Optimization